Chapter 1

Installing Rails

In Part I of this book, we'll introduce you to both the Ruby language and the Rails framework. But we can't get anywhere until you've installed both and verified that they're operating correctly.

To get Rails running on your system, you'll need the following:

- A Ruby interpreter. Rails is written in Ruby, and you'll be writing your applications in Ruby too. Rails 8.0 will run on Ruby versions 3.2, 3.3, and 3.4. It won't work on prior versions of Ruby.
- Ruby on Rails. This book was written using Rails version 8.0 (specifically, Rails 8.0.2).
- Some libraries (depending on the operating system).
- A database. We're using SQLite 3[13] for development. We'll also describe how to deploy with PostgreSQL,[14] but you won't need to install this on your machine.
- Docker. You'll need it when you reach the deployment stage. It can also be used to isolate your development environment from your actual computer.